ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** undervalued girls with physical flaws	Social prejudice.
2	**(a)** he valued money over the bride	Greed.
3	**(c)** Bholi stammered as a child.	Stated fact.
4	**(c)** it brought the idea of a girls' school	Started education.
5	**(a)** it shocks and shames him but also awakens him	Mixed feelings.
6	**(a)** critical	Critical.
7	**(c)** she was considered unlikely to marry	Irony: neglect gave education.
8	**(a)** female empowerment	Empowerment.
9	**(c)** loss of dignity	Humiliation.
10	**(b)** the teacher's patience builds Bholi's confidence	Kindness works.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To show how low she stood in society (1) so that her later courage appears all the more impressive (1).	1+1
12	It forces her to choose between obedience and dignity (1) and she chooses self-respect (1).	1+1
13	It shows the community's label and low expectation (1) and the story proves the label wrong, giving the title irony (1).	1+1
14	The teacher gives respect and encouragement (1) while the family shows worry and neglect (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Education gives Bholi speech, knowledge and confidence. She can understand her worth. It lets her decide against a greedy marriage.	1+1+1
16	Both face hardship. Mathilde suffers from vanity and a lost necklace; Bholi from circumstances and prejudice. Bholi turns hardship into strength through education.	1+1+1
17	(a) What did Bholi do / What was Bholi's problem? (b) Who taught Bholi to read?	1+1+1
	OR: People labelled her simple because of her scars and stammer. Her mother worried about her marriage. Society saw her as a burden.	1+1+1
18	The teacher symbolises hope and the power of education. She represents the kindness that society should show. She changes a life by patience.	1+1+1
	OR: Bholi went to school and learnt to read. Both in simple past.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Statement (1). Bholi's condition before school (1). The teacher's role (1). Her change and refusal (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Place and event (1). Account of dowry demand (1). Bride's response (1). Reaction (1).	2+2+1
20	The groom's demand (1). The father's humiliation (1). Bargaining over a bride (1). Bholi's reaction (1). The moral (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Neglected child (1). Student under a teacher (1). Confident girl (1). Brave woman (1). Final independence (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Bholi an educated girl at the start; she is a **shy, slow girl who stammers**, pock-marked from smallpox, whose real name is **Sulekha**.
- Saying her parents sent her to school gladly; they did so because she was unlikely to be married and school was a *last resort*.
- Giving the wrong reason for refusal: she rejected the groom **Bishamber** because he demanded dowry and was lame, not out of anger.
- Forgetting the teacher: her **kindness** gave Bholi confidence and led to her transformation.
- Mixing the end: Bholi chooses to remain unmarried, **stay and teach** in the village school, and look after her parents.

- Spelling slips: *Bholi, Sulekha, Bishamber, dowry, stammer, Ramlal*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** give power or confidence to	Empower.
2	**(a)** relative clause	Relative.
3	**(d)** greed and disrespect	Dowry demand.
4	**(c)** Why did Bholi find courage only at the wedding?	Needs reasoning.
5	**(d)** self-respect	Self-respect.
6	**(a)** her firm speech at the wedding	Speech and courage.
7	**(a)** even neglect cannot suppress a spirit helped by kindness	Resilience.
8	**(a)** a woman's right to choose and be valued	Agency.
9	**(c)** decided her own future	Independence.
10	**(d)** timid Bholi and bold Bholi	Change.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She will live independently, perhaps as a teacher (1) and will care for her parents on her own terms (1).	1+1
12	He initiates the school (1) and thus indirectly changes Bholi's life (1).	1+1
13	Fear and low confidence caused it (1) and kindness and practice at school removed the fear (1).	1+1
14	As a village official he must set an example (1) which causes Bholi to attend school, a key turning point (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He first shows the preparations and the groom's demand. The tension rises as Ramlal pleads. Then Bholi's sudden refusal forms the climax.	1+1+1
16	Bholi decides her own future. She refuses injustice and accepts responsibility for her parents. This gives the story a note of strength.	1+1+1
17	The simple language fits the village setting. It lets the emotion and moral speak plainly. It makes the story accessible.	1+1+1
	OR: He is shown as greedy and without respect. His demand for dowry reveals his values. He is a negative figure in contrast to Bholi.	1+1+1
18	Bholi looks plain and slow, but she is intelligent and brave. The groom looks respectable but is greedy. Real worth lies within.	1+1+1
	OR: Education delays or changes the old idea of marriage as a girl's only fate. Bholi learns to value herself. She can reject an unjust marriage.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Bholi's example (1). Benefits (1). Barriers (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Introduction (1). Harms of dowry (1). Example of Bholi (1). Appeal (1).	2+2+1
20	Teacher: kind and encouraging (1). Parents: worried and neglectful (1). Effect on Bholi (1). Later change (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Meaning of Bholi (1). The label (1). The story's contradiction (1). Irony (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** ashamed but proud	Mixed.
2	**(d)** to explain why Ramlal had to obey the Tehsildar	Social pressure.
3	**(c)** Bholi was taught to speak by the teacher.	Passive.
4	**(c)** Bholi's courage was admired by everyone.	Passive.
5	**(b)** past perfect	had + V3.
6	**(a)** an unwanted situation led to a good result	Neglect led to schooling.
7	**(b)** to firmly state one's position	Take a stand.
8	**(d)** If Bholi had not gone to school, she would have remained timid.	Third conditional.
9	**(b)** Bishamber was a worthless man.	Judgement.
10	**(d)** A Voice Found	Theme.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	By showing her illnesses and neglect (1) and her helplessness before the world (1).	1+1
12	She faces the world openly (1) and refuses to hide behind convention (1).	1+1
13	The teacher serves as a model for Bholi (1) and Bholi's growth shows the effect of positive example (1).	1+1
14	Confidence from education (1) and a strong sense of self-respect (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It leads to humiliation of the bride's family. It makes marriage a deal and daughters a burden. The story shows it as unjust.	1+1+1
16	(a) Bholi was encouraged by the teacher. (b) The groom was refused by Bholi.	1+1+1
17	At first she is a simpleton and burden. At the end she is a brave girl. Her father and the guests see her worth.	1+1+1
	OR: Bholi, now confident, comforts her father. Her parents see her strength. The relationship changes from neglect to respect.	1+1+1
18	Bholi refused because the groom demanded dowry.	1+1+1
	OR: The title is the nickname that society gave. It shows how people reduced her to a label. By the end the label is untrue.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Entering the mandap (1). Hearing the dowry demand (1). Her thoughts (1). Speaking out and refusing (1). Feelings afterward (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Kindness (1). Patience (1). Faith in students (1). Power to change lives (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Nickname versus reality (1). Neglect leads to schooling (1). Plain girl is the bravest (1). The groom's greed shames him (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: State your view (1). Groom's greed (1). Self-respect (1). Alternative plan (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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